# Types of phrases

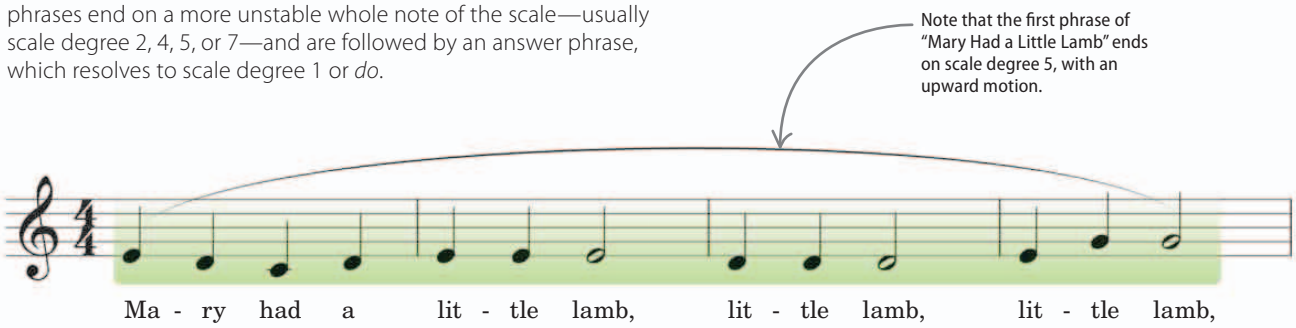
**Phrases often work together in pairs. The relationship between two phrases may be characterized as question-and-answer, call-and-response, or antecedent and consequent.**


**SEE ALSO**

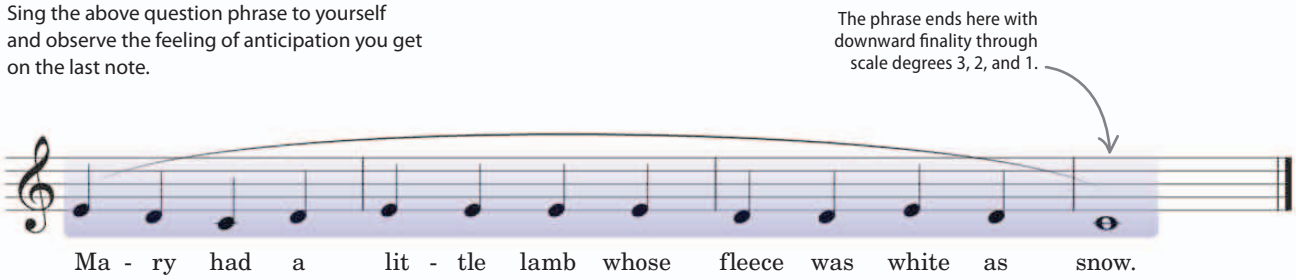
| | |
|---|---|
| ❮ **94–95** Phrasing and phrase marks | |
| Analyzing melodies | **108–109** ❯ |
| Harmony | **118–119** ❯ |
| Degrees of the scale | **124–125** ❯ |


## Question-and-answer phrases

A question phrase doesn't sound complete on its own. Question phrases end on a more unstable whole note of the scale—usually scale degree 2, 4, 5, or 7—and are followed by an answer phrase, which resolves to scale degree 1 or *do*.



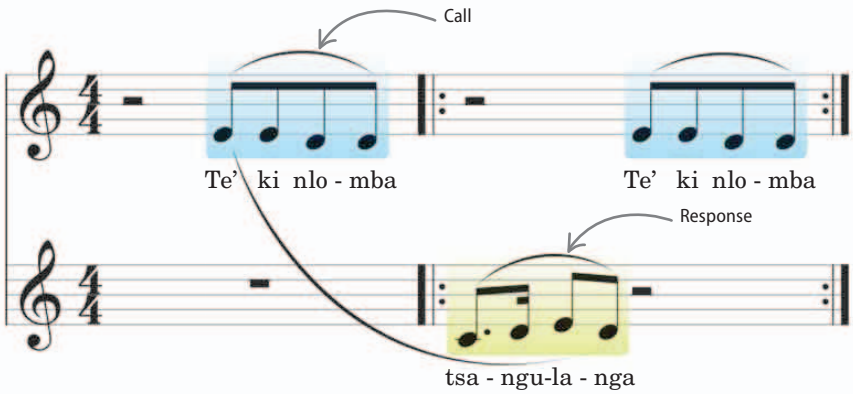

△ **Unfinished melody**
Sing the above question phrase to yourself and observe the feeling of anticipation you get on the last note.




△ **Answering phrases**
Note that the answer phrase is the same length as the question phrase, but it ends on scale degree 1. This gives the phrase ending a sense of finality.

## Call-and-response

Call-and-response phrases have been used as communication in various cultures, including many in Africa and India. In these, one player might play or sing a message (the "call") and another performer would reply musically (the "response").




▷ **Yombe children's game song**
In this example, the leader sings, "the slender plantain," and the chorus sing, "pick it up".There is no break between the two parts so it sounds like one phrase.